

Romanticism as Border Crossing: The Case of the Symphonic Mass

Eftychia Papanikolaou

Romantic music inherited from the previous eras the High Mass, a genre that was closely bound up with the church, a setting for primarily liturgical purposes. Since the early Renaissance, the text of the Latin Ordinary has constituted the most frequently-set sacred text, with the added peculiarity that it has remained unchangeable in its overall form over the centuries. From Palestrina to Lou Harrison (b. 1917), composers have set the Kyrie, Gloria, Credo, Sanctus, and Agnus Dei to polyphonic music.

By the end of the eighteenth century composers had adopted styles and modes of writing for the church that, more often than not, alluded to a strong cross-fertilization between instrumental and operatic genres. Eventually, under the pervading spirit of Romanticism, composers began to redefine the Mass as a genre, so that gradually the boundaries between sacred and secular, the church and the concert hall, began to blur. Nowhere did this attitude become more apparent than in the symphonic

Mass of the Austro-German tradition, which emerged as the antipode of symphonic music in the nineteenth century. The tendency of the two genres to gradually come closer together, as works that were both equally at home in the church and the concert hall, culminated in the inevitable fusion in the two by the end of the century. This paper will provide a new overview of select critical and musical responses to the Romantic symphonic Mass.

For centuries, the Mass constituted the crux and nucleus of liturgical practices in the Habsburg lands. Although music for worship changed style numerous times throughout the centuries, in Vienna Mass compositions formed an indispensable part of the Catholic service. By the end of the eighteenth century Viennese churches had cultivated a hybrid music style that often bordered on the operatic. The following eyewitness account of 1784 is a case in point:

With respect to composition, Catholic Church music up until several years ago still had much of its own special character. But nowadays operatic music also forces its way into churches everywhere, and, what is worse, [it is] the insipid Italian opera music of the new style. In Vienna, too, I found it all too conspicuous. During many a Credo or Benedictus I knew not whether perhaps I was hearing music from an Italian *opera buffa*.¹

Such an indictment against contemporary musical practices reflects the threat that church music was perceived to face against a traditional status quo that had persisted well into the Baroque, seen also in the writings of music theorists of the time. In his major theoretical work *Gradus ad Parnassum* (1725), Viennese Hofkapellmeister Johann Joseph Fux asserted that the chief purpose of church music during service was “zur Erweckung der Andacht” (“to arouse devotion”).² In the same vein, in an article of 15 October 1737 in the *Critischer Musikus*, Johann Adolf Scheibe stated: “Es ist aber der Hauptendzweck der Kirchenmusik vornehmlich, die Zuhörer zu erbauen, sie zur Andacht aufmuntern, um dadurch bei ihnen eine stille und heilige Ehrfurcht gegen das göttliche Wesen zu erwecken” (“The chief purpose of church music is principally to edify the listeners, to encourage their prayer so as to thereby awaken in them a quiet and holy reverence before God’s presence”).³ Thus infiltration of operatic practices and elaborate instrumental music into the

previously accepted performance practices were naturally regarded as qualities that hampered religious *Andacht*.

It has often been observed that the decrees Joseph II promulgated in the 1780s concerning the Church, including those that limited the performances of elaborate music in churches, were responsible for the scarcity of church compositions at the end of the eighteenth century. Joseph’s decrees, however, did not eliminate concerted music from the service, but rather regulated it for financial purposes.⁴ Even if Joseph’s reforms discouraged the composition of concerted Mass settings for the church, a ruling that aimed more at the clergy than church composers, that decree was not long-lived. Archduke Leopold II, his brother and successor to the throne in 1790 (until 1792), reinstated the performance of orchestral church music.

It is true, nonetheless, that the two principal composers of Viennese classicism, Wolfgang Amadé Mozart (1756–91) and Joseph Haydn (1732–1809), did not write profusely for the church—a fact that may be attributed primarily to institutional reasons. Sacred music may be peripheral to their output, but their masses constitute no less than a summation of stylistic elements that had become commonplace in church music practices of the eighteenth century. Of the thirty—or so—Mass settings by Mozart and Haydn, only a small number broke stylistically with the past: Mozart’s incomplete Mass in C minor, K. 427 (1782–83) and Requiem, K. 626 (1791), and Haydn’s six late masses.

Haydn’s late masses (written between 1796 and 1802) were intended for the name-day celebrations of Princess Marie Hermengilde (née von Liechtenstein), Prince Nikolaus Esterházy’s wife. These works helped pioneer a “symphonic” outlook because they appropriated idioms typically associated with symphonic music: recurrence of thematic ideas, use of symphonic forms, thematic development, breadth, and continuity. When Prince Nikolaus commissioned Ludwig van Beethoven (1770–1827) to compose a Mass for the same occasion in 1807, he composed his first Mass in C, Op. 86. Unlike Haydn’s masses, when this work was first performed in Eisenstadt on 13 September 1807, it was received with utmost dislike by the Prince. He reportedly described it as “unerträglich, lächerlich und scheußlich” (“unbearably ridiculous and detestable”),⁵ possibly unconsciously voicing an inevitable comparison with Haydn’s masses, works which the Prince greatly admired.⁶ Consequently, Beethoven’s early Mass in C and, especially, the *Missa*

solemnis, manifest qualities that became emblematic of the new “symphonic” style, an ideal that betrayed an allegiance to the essence and character of emerging Romantic thought.

The changing attitudes in the state of religious music in the beginning of the nineteenth century could not have escaped the pen of as astute a writer as composer and critic E. T. A. Hoffmann (1776–1822). A staunch advocate of Beethoven’s symphonic music, in 1813 Hoffmann wrote a sympathetic review of Beethoven’s Mass in C for the *Allgemeine musikalische Zeitung*, in which he praised the Mass for its structure and imaginative orchestration. The lack of strictly executed fugues, however, did not escape Hoffmann’s criticism, since contrapuntal writing had for centuries been considered a representation of “den reisten Kirchensatz” (“the purest church style”).⁷

Hoffmann continued his advocacy of older church styles the following year in his influential “Alte und neue Kirchenmusik” (“Old and New Church Music”), published in 1814 in the *Allgemeine musikalische Zeitung*. When in this article Hoffmann lamented the decline of church music, he was certainly not concerned with the state of affairs in individual church establishments, but with high art as manifest in sacred music in the output of major artists of the time. After an overview of religious music of all periods, he concluded:

In der letzten Hälfte des achtzehnten Jahrhunderts brach nun endlich jene Verweichlichung, jene ekle Süßlichkeit in die Kunst ein, die, mit der sogenannten, allen tieferen religiösen Sinn tötenden Aufklärerei gleichen Schritt haltend und immer steigend, zuletzt allen Ernst, alle Würde aus der Kirchenmusik verbannte.... Sind nun ... auch die Haydnschen Messen und kirchlichen Hymnen, vorzüglich im Vergleich jener alten, wahrhaft heiligen, von der Erde verschwundenen Musik, durchaus nicht Muster des Kirchenstils zu nennen.

(In the last half of the eighteenth century increasing enfeeblement and sickly sweetness finally overcame art; keeping step with so-called enlightened attitudes, which killed every deeper religious impulse, it eventually drove all gravity and dignity from church music.... It is clear ... that Haydn’s masses and church hymns cannot stand as models of church style, particularly compared with that truly sacred music of former times which has now vanished from the earth.)⁸

Hoffmann acknowledged only two masterpieces of genuine sacred music of “former times”: Handel’s *Messiah* and Mozart’s *Requiem*. Interestingly enough, Beethoven’s Mass in C was not included in this canon of great sacred works. Actually, Beethoven’s name was mentioned only once, alongside those of Haydn’s and Mozart’s, in an attempt to attribute the triumvirate’s unorthodox style of their masses to the “frivolity and ignorance” of the eighteenth century.⁹ The Mass in C, a work that, according to Hoffmann, betrayed Beethoven’s indebtedness to Haydn’s late masses but also certain new, nonconformist attitudes, is here conspicuously ignored. Not even Hoffmann, one of the chief exponents of Beethoven’s music, was able to foresee the thrust of Beethoven’s transformative power on the genre—a remarkable foreshadowing of the perplexity with which the *Missa solemnis* was later received as well.¹⁰

In fact, Beethoven’s *Missa solemnis* (1819–23) emerged as the quintessential symphonic mass in the early part of the nineteenth century. An utterly personal and idiosyncratic work, one that explores the norms of Romanticism newly articulated by the Schlegel brothers, this mass was written in a style that suited the pomp and circumstance of the occasion it was supposed to honor: the appointment of Archduke Rudolph, brother of the reigning Emperor Leopold II and the most important of the composer’s patrons, as Archbishop of Olmütz. Although Beethoven conceived of the work in terms of a liturgical performance (and, indeed, it would have been performed in the church during the ceremony), the *Missa solemnis* was early on deemed to be unsuitable for the church as a liturgical work. It was too long, posing enormous difficulties to both vocalists and instrumentalists, and impossible for any church orchestra and chorus to handle—consequently, it was rarely performed in the church in the nineteenth century.

As has often been pointed out, and most recently by Maynard Solomon, “the piece has never been at home in either concert hall or church. On several occasions Beethoven suggested that it would be performed as ‘a grand oratorio’ (adding parenthetically, ‘for the benefit of the poor’), and he was not disturbed to learn that at its first performance in St. Petersburg it was indeed presented as an oratorio.”¹¹ Indeed, the concert hall proved a more suitable venue for the *Missa solemnis*. On the program of the concert of 7 May 1824 at the Kärntnertortheater, an event that highlighted the premiere of his Ninth Symphony (finished in the same year as the *Missa solemnis*), Beethoven included three movements

from the *Missa sollemnis*. Interestingly enough, the Kyrie, Credo and Agnus Dei had to appear as “Three Hymns” on the program due to strict censorship laws in Metternich’s Vienna that forbade church music to be performed in the concert hall. Ten years before, Hoffmann had condemned such secularization of music intended for worship, “denn diese Musik ist ja der *Kultus selbst* und daher eine Missa im Konzert eine Predigt im Theater” (“because such music is *worship itself*, and this seems like a mass celebrated in a concert, or a sermon preached in a theatre”).¹² Had Hoffmann lived to hear the *Missa sollemnis* performed on the concert stage, he might have changed his mind—or not.

At a time when sacred music was primarily the occupation of church composers and demand for church music was minimal,¹³ Beethoven made an important statement. He modified the liturgical Mass, turning it into a work that texturally and formally resembled his symphonic output, and aesthetically it presented a perfect vehicle for the Romantic composers’ expression of their predilection for the monumental, the lofty, and the sublime. Thus the *Missa sollemnis* foreshadowed the significance, role, and status that religious music would acquire in the rest of the nineteenth century, as music of personal faith, music which belongs equally to the church as well as to the concert hall. It may not be a coincidence that in 1802, at the dawn of the nineteenth century, a major music theorist such as Christoph Koch wrote in his *Musikalisches Lexicon* that, “Die Kirchenmusik erscheine in welcher Form sie wolle, so muß sie notwendig den Character der Feierlichkeit und Andacht behaupten” (“Church music may appear in whatever form it wants so long as it maintains the character of solemnity and devotion”).¹⁴

In the early nineteenth century, then, the Romantic symphonic Mass, the sacred music genre *par excellence*, appealed to Romantic composers for its universality and canonic status. Gradually under the influence of Romantic aesthetics, the Mass as a musical genre lost its strictly liturgical place in the church, as music principally intended for worship; it became “aestheticized,” and its musical setting now served as much to glorify God as it revealed the composers’ subjective approach to the text. Thus, doctrinal credo was filtered through the composer’s personal credo.

This was in keeping with the tendency toward secularization in the mid-nineteenth century. The texts of the Bible, in particular, offered possibilities for limitless interpretations through each artist’s subjective vision. Their “canonic” status had been called into question before, but

never as intensely as in the nineteenth century. Gradually the Bible started to attain a condition equal to that primarily associated with the literary canon, namely a corpus of secular writings whose perennial value transcends cultures and eras but which is also susceptible to constant re-evaluation and interpretation. “The Bible then,” David Jasper has asserted, “begins to emerge as part of a great ‘secular’ literature whose canon is shifting and continually needs to be reassessed within culture and society.”¹⁵ Thus, critical Romantic thought “allowed the Bible to be read ‘as literature,’”¹⁶ thus also exposing it to critique (take Strauss’s *Das Leben Jesu* as a perfect example of a book that would have never been written had it not been for the dissolution of those boundaries).¹⁷

As a result, composers approached the sacred word with a renewed energy and subjectivity, which was subsequently reflected in their music. Under this practice, a work such as Johannes Brahms’s *Deutsches Requiem*, Op. 45 (1854–68) which included diverse passages chosen from Luther’s translation of the Bible, would lose its liturgical garb and become a work suitable for the concert hall. Its novelty did not simply rest on the choice of language, German instead of Latin, but also the rather “random” but inspired assemblage of Biblical texts that Brahms deemed suitable for replacing the “canonical” text of the Latin Requiem.¹⁸

Similarly, works of secular literature would be “canonized” through musical treatment that was primarily reserved for sacred compositions. Robert Schumann’s *Requiem für Mignon*, Op. 98b (1849) was inspired by a secular text, Goethe’s *Wilhelm Meister*, but clothed musically in sounds of explicit sacred overtones, with the added allusion of the title to a genre—Requiem—that for centuries had been associated with Biblical text and ecclesiastical context. Thus, religious language could not only be found in the Bible, but also in literary texts—Heinrich Heine’s famous dictum that Goethe’s *Faust* had become “die weltliche Bibel der Deutschen” (“the secular Bible of the Germans”)¹⁹ exemplified a duality that would be consistent throughout the nineteenth century, namely, that secular texts could be revered as highly as any excerpt from the Bible, and thus treated in a manner that would fuse secular interpretation with religious reverence. Since Romantic composers tended to approach the Bible as just another literary text, they also tended to treat the Latin Ordinary with the type of subjectivity they would accord to a secular text. Thus, the church became the focus of “aesthetic experience,” while

the concert hall became the locus of reconciliation between the sacred and the secular, religion and art.²⁰

Thus, by the middle of the nineteenth century, Romantic music aesthetics reached an apogee when the *Zukunftsmusik* ("music of the future") controversy affected the realm of sacred music composition as well. The issue of the ideal "church music of the future" seems to have concerned many Romantic thinkers, too. On the occasion of the premiere of part of Robert Schumann's *Scenen aus Goethes Faust* ("Scenes from Goethe's *Faust*," 1844–53) in Leipzig in 1849, the critic who had succeeded Schumann as editor of the *Neue Zeitschrift für Musik* in 1845, Franz Brendel, published a review in that journal. In this work, Schumann set the final scene of Goethe's *Faust* to music of unmistakable Romantic character, thus adding to the text's transcendental imagery. Brendel realized the sacred implications of such a vivid representation of Goethe's quasi-religious text, especially in the concluding scene, which in his review he identified as the "Kirchenmusik der Zukunft" ("church music of the future").²¹ Thus, by implication, the ideal church music of the future would fuse musical genres and artistic styles, transcend the boundaries of liturgical performance, defy adherence to predetermined dogmatic texts, and borrow from the world of opera characteristics associated with dramatic presentation, a notion of "genre-bending" at the heart of Romanticism's norms.

The musical world could find no better-suited composer to fulfill those aspirations than Franz Liszt (1811–1886). Liszt's antithetical personality, constantly vacillating between preserving tradition and revolutionizing music, between religious devotion and artistic iconoclasm, pervades his entire creative output. Nowhere, however, is this spirit more prominent than in his approach to sacred music, and specifically in his settings of the Ordinary of the Mass. The genesis of Franz Liszt's masses is inextricably linked with the Roman Catholic Church. To trace Liszt's involvement with church music, we have to go back to his years in Paris when, in 1834, he authored a long article, "De la situation des artistes" ("On the Situation of Artists"). Published in French in the *Revue et gazette musicale* of 30 August 1835, the last section, titled "De la musique religieuse," constitutes a manifesto of Liszt's thoughts on church music,²² in which he laments the decline of religion and seeks to establish the criteria for the ideal church music of his day.

Influenced by Saint-Simonian socialist philosophy²³ and the religious ideas of the unorthodox reformer Hughes Félicité Robert de Lamennais (early in 1834 Liszt had stayed for a month with Abbé Lamennais and took copious notes of their talks),²⁴ Liszt expressed his wish to bring Catholic religion closer to the people by going back to its roots. His own agenda in relation to music included two different approaches: first, that the church should reintroduce plainchant (but harmonized), and second that the music of Renaissance musicians, and especially Palestrina, should serve as models for the composition of new sacred works. Liszt, however, did not advocate empty imitation of parochial musical languages, but rather *emulation* of older venerable styles. That is why, alongside his panegyric of older music and advocacy of a return to the original mysticism of religion, at the same time he also presents himself as a fervent proponent of a new kind of church music which would embrace the most progressive elements of contemporary music, especially its tendency toward expansiveness and theatricality. In his article we read:

[L]a musique doit s'enquérir du PEUPLE et de DIEU; aller de l'un à l'autre; améliorer, moraliser, consoler l'homme, bénir et glorifier Dieu. Or, pour cela faire, la création d'une musique nouvelle est imminente, essentiellement religieuse, forte et agissante, cette musique qu'à défaut d'autre nom nous appellerons humanitaire, résumera dans de colossales proportions le THÉÂTRE et L'ÉGLISE. Elle sera à la fois dramatique et sacrée, pompeuse et simple, pathétique et grave, ardente et échevelée, tempêteuse et calme, sereine et tendre.... [T]outes les classes, enfin, se confondront dans un sentiment commun, religieux, grandiose et sublime. Ce sera le FIAT LUX de l'art.

([M]usic must concern itself with PEOPLE and GOD, hastening from the one to the other, improving, edifying, and comforting mankind while it blesses and glorifies God. And to bring this about, the creation of new music is imminent. Essentially religious, powerful, and stirring, that music, which for want of another name we will call humanistic music, will sum up both the THEATER and the CHURCH on a colossal scale. It will be at once both dramatic and sacred, stately and simple, moving and solemn, fiery and unruly, tempestuous yet calm, serene and gentle.... [A]ll classes of people will be joined together in a common, religious, grand and sublime feeling. This will be the FIAT LUX of art.)²⁵

Underneath Liszt's elaborate prose lies a manifesto for a type of church music that comes close in character to the most expansive secular works written in the early part of the century. What Liszt proposes here comes very close to a fusion of sacred "ideas" and secular "styles," to paraphrase a well-known phrase; or, the "church music of the future" will ideally be represented by works that unite sacred content and secular forms. With the use of thematic transformation, a technique he would master later, the content would dictate the form of the piece—so that the secular would be free to infiltrate the sacred.

All of Liszt's masses were composed to be performed in the church. Both of his most brilliant masses, the *Gran Mass* (1855) and the *Hungarian Coronation Mass* (1867) were mainly celebratory works; but they were also given "concert performances," as Paul Merrick has observed, "taking their place alongside those orchestral Masses usually heard only in the concert hall, chief among them of course Beethoven's *Missa solemnis*."²⁶ In that respect, Liszt's two symphonic masses stand as monuments of the most progressive tendencies of the period, especially in their expansiveness and overt theatricality.

By the late nineteenth century, the practice of performing sacred works in the concert hall was not simply accepted, but had become a commonplace. Carl Dahlhaus reminds us that "Ob sich durch die Komposition einer Konzertmesse der Konzertsaal in eine Kirche oder die Messe in ein Konzertstück verwandelte, war unter den Voraussetzungen des 19. Jahrhunderts kaum noch unterscheidbar" ("by nineteenth-century criteria, it was virtually impossible to tell whether a composer of a concert mass had turned the concert hall into a church or the mass into a concert piece").²⁷ Around the same time, Giuseppe Verdi (1813–1901) shook the musical world with his *Requiem* (1874), a work so operatic in conception that it prompted the ire of many conservative musicians.²⁸ One day before the Viennese performance, the conductor Hans von Bülow printed a "virulent report" in the *Allgemeine musikalische Zeitung*, calling the work an "Oper im Kirchengewande" ("opera in ecclesiastical costume").²⁹ On the other hand, even as conservative a critic as Eduard Hanslick could not but acknowledge the Romanticized trends of the time. He recognized that, by having his *Requiem* performed in concert halls all around Europe, Verdi "der jeni-gen Gemeinde vorzuführen, welcher es in Wahrheit gewidmet war: der

musikalischen" ("introduced it to the congregation for which it was really intended—the musical community"). Hanslick argued that suitability for the church was no longer a valid criterion for sacred music; his thoughts on contemporary church music are worth quoting at length:

Spricht aus einem modernen Kirchenstück ehrliche Ueberzeugung und ernste Schönheit, dann mögen wir uns zufrieden geben; die Frage nach der specifisch kirchlichen Qualifikation wird täglich immer bedenklicher und haltloser. Es ist Zeit, sich einmal darüber klar zu erden. Angesichts von geistlichen Compositionen denken wir heutzutage doch vor Allem an das Kunstwerk; was die Kirche als solche daran zu loben oder zu tadeln findet, ist uns sehr gleichgiltig [*sic*].... Wir Kinder der Zeit erblicken hingegen in dem *Stabat Mater*, dem Requiem, selbst im Meßtext eine Dichtung, allerdings eine durch Inhalt und Tradition geheiligte Dichtung, welche der Componist als Stoff für seine Kunst verwendet. Was er daraus schafft, gilt uns für ein Werk freier Kunst, welches das Recht seiner Existenz in sich selbst, in seiner künstlerischen GröÙe und Schönheit trägt, nicht in seiner kirchlichen Zweckmäßigkeit. Wir denken mit Einem Worte bei solchen Schöpfungen unserer modernen Meister an den Musiksaal, nicht an die Kirche und diese Meister denken ebenso. Das war ganz anders in früheren Zeiten. Haydn und Mozart kam es niemals in den Sinn, daß ihre Messen anderswo als im Gotteshause aufzuführen seien. Sie schrieben ihre Kirchenmusik für den Gebrauch der Kirche.... Auf zwanzig Concert-Productionen dieser Werke kommt vielleicht Eine Kirchaufführung, und diese gilt dann ausdrücklich als Concert in der Kirche, das sich zunächst an die Musikfreunde wendet, nicht an die Beter.

(We should be satisfied with a piece of modern church music if it expresses honest conviction and sincere beauty. The question of specific churchly qualifications grows daily more dubious and immaterial. It is time to clarify the matter. In regard to sacred music we tend nowadays to listen to and appraise it as art. What the church finds in it to praise or blame is a matter of indifference.... We children of our time ... see in the *Stabat Mater*, the Requiem, even in the text of the Mass, a poem hallowed by content and tradition, but still a poem at the service of the composer as material for his work. What he makes of it is, for us, a work of free art, whose right to exist is embodied in its own artistic greatness and beauty, not in its usefulness to the church.

In a word, we think of the concert hall rather than the church, and so do the masters. It used to be otherwise. It never occurred to Haydn and Mozart that their Masses would ever be performed elsewhere than in the church. [They wrote their church music for use in the church.] ... For every twenty performances of [sacred] works in concert halls [nowadays] there is perhaps one in a church, and this rather for music lovers than for parishioners.)³⁰

The poetic underpinnings of the liturgical text of the Mass would no longer lay hidden. The infiltration of operatic elements into sacred music was now understood less as a result of a stylistically shared musical language, as viewed a century before, than as a necessity for composers to employ their entire arsenal of musical styles in order to reveal the text's subjective qualities.

It is pertinent that we view this repertory in its wider context as a reflection of, and at the same time reaction to, the various ideologies of the time, ranging from strictly religious to political. The Romantic composers' answer to the fusion of the sacred and the secular, or what Dahlhaus has eloquently called "die Säkularisierung des Religiösen und die Sakralisierung von Profanem" ("the secularization of the religious and sanctification of the profane"),³¹ would have immense implications for twentieth-century musical aesthetics. What they exemplified in the Romantic symphonic masses did not simply concern the move from the church to the concert hall. It also epitomized a move from private to public, a symbolic gesture of private subjectivity entering the public sphere.

Examining the evolutionary trajectory of the Romantic Mass means acknowledging that some of the same forces that helped shape and redefine the genre over the period of the "long" nineteenth century, are still at play today. At a time of religious, cultural, political, and ideological intersections, discussions involving historical relativism, religious hermeneutics, secularization and, last but not least, the separation of church and state, are strikingly contemporary, and may help us decipher the continuity of a musical process that began almost two centuries ago.

Notes

1. The description comes from Friedrich Christoph Nicolai, a Prussian book dealer, who visited Vienna in 1781 and recorded his impressions in his *Beschreibung einer Reise durch Deutschland und die Schweiz im Jahre 1781* (Berlin, 1784). The translation is cited in Bruce C. Mac Intyre, *The Viennese Concerted Mass of the Early Classic Period* (Ann Arbor, Michigan: UMI Research Press, 1986), 54. Cf. Cornell Jesse Runestad, "The Masses of Joseph Haydn: A Stylistic Study," PhD diss. (University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign, 1970), 40.

2. Johann Joseph Fux, *Gradus ad parnassum, oder Anführung zur regelmäßigen musikalischen Composition*, trans. Lorenz Mizlern (Leipzig: Mizlerischen Buchverlag, 1742), 181–182.

3. Johann Adolf Scheibe, in an article of 15 October 1737 in the *Critischer Musikus* (Leipzig: Breitkopf, 1745), 161. Translation cited in Mac Intyre, *The Viennese Concerted Mass*, 41. Johann Georg Albrechtsberger, concurred that the aim of church music was not amusement but "Andacht und Ehre Gottes" ("prayer and the honor of God"); in *Gründliche Anweisung zur Composition* (Leipzig, 1790), 378.

4. See Reinhard G. Pauly, "The Reforms of Church Music under Joseph II," *Musical Quarterly* 43 (1957): 372ff.

5. In a letter to the Countess Henriette Von Zielinska, the Prince wrote: "Die Messe von Beethoven ist unerträglich, lächerlich und scheuflüch, ich bin nicht davon überzeugt, daß sie überhaupt anständig aufzuführen wäre; ich bin deshalb wütend und beschämt." ("Beethoven's Mass is unbearably ridiculous and detestable, and I am not sure that it can ever be performed properly. I am angry and mortified.") In Johann Harich, "Beethoven in Eisenstadt," *Burgenlaendische Heimatblätter* 21 (1959): 179. Original letter in French.

6. Beethoven himself also feared such a comparison. When he wrote to Prince Esterházy in the summer of 1807 informing him that the Mass was almost complete, he closed the letter by adding: "... ich Ihnen mit viel Furcht die Messe übergeben werde, da Sie d. F. gewohnt sind, die unnachahmlichen Meisterstücke des großen Haydn sich vortragen zu lassen." ("[W]ith much fear I shall hand to you the Mass, since you, most serene prince, are accustomed to hear the inimitable masterpieces of the great Haydn.") *Ludwig van Beethovens sämtliche Briefe*, ed. Emerich Kastner (Tutzing: Hans Schneider, 1975), 108. Translation in *Beethoven's Letters*, trans. J. S. Shedlock (New York: Dover, 1972), 70.

7. "C-Dur Messe Op. 86," in E. T. A. Hoffmann, *Musikalische Novellen und Aufsätze, Band II: Musikalische Aufsätze*, ed. Edgar Istel (Regensburg: Gustav Bosse, 1921), 76–95, esp. 81. Translated as "Review of Beethoven's Mass in C [1813]," in E. T. A. Hoffmann's *Musical Writings: Kreisleriana, The Poet and the Composer, Music Criticism*, trans. Martyn Clarke & ed. David Charlton (New York: Cambridge University Press, 1989), 325–341, esp. 329.

8. "Alte und neue Kirchenmusik," in E. T. A. Hoffmann, *Musikalische Novellen und Aufsätze, Band II: Musikalische Aufsätze*, 131 and 133. Translated as "Old and New

Church Music," in *E. T. A. Hoffmann's Musical Writings: Kreisleriana, The Poet and the Composer, Music Criticism*, 370 and 371.

9. "Haydn, Mozart, Beethoven entfalteten eine neue Kunst, deren erster Keim sich wohl eben erst in der Mitte des achtzehnten Jahrhunderts zeigte. Daß der Leichtsin, der Unverstand mit dem erworbenen Reichtum übel haushaltete, daß endlich Falschmünzer ihrem Rauschgolde das Ansehen der Gediegenheit geben wollten, war nicht die Schuld jener Meister, in denen sich der Geist so herrlich offenbarte." ("Haydn, Mozart and Beethoven have evolved a new art, whose earliest beginnings can be traced only to the middle of the eighteenth century. It was not the fault of these composers, in whom the spirit was so gloriously manifest, that frivolity and ignorance squandered the wealth that had been so hard won, and that finally counterfeiters tried to give their tinsel productions the semblance of authenticity.") "Alte und neue Kirchenmusik," in *E. T. A. Hoffmann, Musikalische Novellen und Aufsätze, Band II: Musikalische Aufsätze*, 135; translated in "Old and New Church Music," in *E. T. A. Hoffmann's Musical Writings: Kreisleriana, The Poet and the Composer, Music Criticism*, 372.

10. For a comprehensive study on the reception of Beethoven's music see *The Critical Reception of Beethoven's Compositions by his German Contemporaries*, ed. Wayne M. Senner, Robin Wallace, and William Meredith (Lincoln: University of Nebraska Press, 1999-). See also *Ludwig van Beethoven: Die Werke im Spiegel seiner Zeit Gesammelte Konzertberichte und Rezensionen bis 1830*, ed. Stefan Kunze (Laaber: Laaber Verlag, 1987).

11. Maynard Solomon, *Beethoven* (New York: Schirmer Books, 1977), 307.

12. "Alte und neue Kirchenmusik," in *E. T. A. Hoffmann, Musikalische Novellen und Aufsätze, Band II: Musikalische Aufsätze*, 140; translated in "Old and New Church Music," in *E. T. A. Hoffmann's Musical Writings: Kreisleriana, The Poet and the Composer, Music Criticism*, 375.

13. Beethoven had first-hand experience of the time's contemporary attitude to sacred music, as he bitterly remarked when he was forced to give his Mass in C for publication in 1808 without a fee. Breitkopf & Härtel responded that simply there was "no demand for church works" ("Man fragt nicht nach Kirchensachen"). See *Ludwig van Beethovens sämtliche Briefe*, ed. Emerich Kastner (Tutzing: Hans Schneider, 1975), 115. Translation in Emily Anderson, *The Letters of Beethoven*, vol. I, 190–191 & 235.

14. Heinrich Christoph Koch, "Kirchenmusik," in *Musikalisches Lexicon* (Frankfurt am Main, 1802), col. 832. Translation in Mac Intyre, *The Viennese Concerted Mass*, 42 and 690, n. 80.

15. David Jasper, *The Sacred and Secular Canon in Romanticism: Preserving the Sacred Truths* (New York: St. Martin's Press, 1999), 2.

16. *Ibid.*, 4.

17. David Friedrich Strauss (1808–1874) added to the polemical tone of contemporary religious thinking with the publication of his two-volume work *Das Leben Jesu, kritisch bearbeitet* (*The Life of Jesus Critically Examined*, 1835–36), in which he proposed a critical examination of the Gospels. A Protestant theologian by training, Strauss argued that the life of Jesus should be viewed from a historical perspective, without placing emphasis on the mythical elements that found their way into the Gospel—a point of view that, surprisingly, still resonates in current theological discussions. His liberal biblical

and theological scholarship caused controversy at the time, and instigated a critical examination of Christianity.

18. For a most recent account of these aspects in Brahms's music see Daniel Beller-McKenna, *Brahms and the German Spirit* (Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press, 2004), esp. chapters 2 and 3.

19. Heinrich Heine, *Die romantische Schule* (Halle a Saale: Otto Hendel, [n.d.]), 36. English translation of "The Romantic School," in *The Romantic School and Other Essays*, trans. Helen Mustard & ed. Jost Hermand & Robert C. Holub (New York: Continuum, 1985), 40.

20. The latter dialectic, or rapprochement, would also later serve as the title of one of Richard Wagner's most celebrated essays, "Religion und Kunst" ("Religion and Art," 1880), a bold attempt to demonstrate that art would eventually substitute for religion. In its famous opening lines, Wagner was willing to see in art (and naturally in the artist) the role of a savior of degenerate religion: "Man könnte sagen, daß da, wo die Religion künstlich wird, der Kunst es vorbehalten sei den Kern der Religion zu retten, indem sie die mythischen Symbole, welche die erstere im eigentlichen Sinne als wahr geglaubt wissen will, ihrem sinnbildlichen Werte nach ersaßt, um durch ideale Darstellung derselben die in ihnen verborgene tiefe Wahrheit erkennen zu lassen." ("One could say that just where religion starts to become artificial, the responsibility for its preservation devolves upon art itself; for art takes those same mythic symbols that religion has posited as veritable truths and uses them for their metaphorical value, revealing by means of their idealized presentation the deep levels of truth contained in them.") Richard Wagner, "Religion und Kunst" in *Gesammelte Schriften und Dichtungen* (Leipzig: Breitkopf und Härtel, 1912–1914), vol. 9, 211. Translation in *The Wagner Compendium*, ed. Barry Millinger (New York: Schirmer Books, 1992), 234.

21. *Neue Zeitschrift für Musik* 31 (1849): 115; cited by John Daverio in *Robert Schumann: Herald of a "New Poetic Age"* (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 1997), 384. Daverio also sees in Schumann's musical setting "the tension between archaicism and modernity as a dialectic between the sacred and the profane." Being a composition that also defies genre designation, he views it as an "encyclopedic array of genres: church music, oratorio, horror opera, grand opera, lied, symphony." *Ibid.*, 385–387. In 1906, Gustav Mahler also wrote music for the same text, which comprised the second movement of his Eighth Symphony (1906). Comparable sacred overtones characterize his musical setting, and the work as a whole has been viewed with similar skepticism as to its generic classification. See my "The Religious Impulse in Schumann's and Mahler's Settings of Goethe's *Faust*," *Natur laut* 4/2 (2005): 11–17.

22. Franz Liszt, "De la situation des artistes et de leur condition dans la société," in *Sämtliche Schriften, Band I: Frühe Schriften*, ed. Rainer Kleinertz (Leipzig: Breitkopf und Härtel, 2000), 2–65. "De la musique religieuse," which constitutes part of the article, became better known as "Über zukünftige Kirchenmusik" ("On the Church Music of the Future") due to Lina Ramann's editorial change in the *Gesammelte Schriften* edition (1880–83).

23. When in Paris, Liszt became acquainted with the teachings of Claude Henri, Comte de Saint-Simon (1760–1825), the influential French socialist philosopher and social reformer. His social doctrines, developed into a system called Saint-Simonianism,

advocated (among other things) a type of “new Christianity” that is not connected with any existing church, but aims to foster social equality, “the emancipation of women, the abolition of hereditary rights, and the equitable distribution of wealth throughout a new classless society” controlled by scientists and industrialists. The group was disbanded in 1832, but its ideas had a profound influence on young Liszt; cf. Adrian Williams, *Portrait of Liszt By Himself and His Contemporaries* (Oxford: Clarendon, 1990), 39.

24. “Paroles d’un Croyant” by Abbé Hughes Félicité Robert de Lamennais (1782–1854) was published in July 1834, a little after his meeting with Liszt in April 1834, and in many ways Liszt’s 1835 article is an echo of the ideas propagated in that work. Lamennais was enthusiastic about his acquaintance with Liszt (see Williams, *Portrait of Liszt By Himself and His Contemporaries*, 62), and Liszt was captivated by Lamennais’s teachings on the separation of church and state. Liszt wrote to him: “I can’t resist telling you ... how your pages have transported, overwhelmed, torn me to pieces with pain and hope!... My God, but they are sublime!... What genius, what charity!... From this date it is evident, not only to those chosen souls who have loved and followed you for a long time, but to the whole world, that Christianity in the nineteenth century, which is to say the whole religious and political future of humanity is in you!... Oh, you won’t fail.” Cited in Eleanor Perényi, *Liszt: The Artist as Romantic Hero* (Boston: Little, Brown and Company, 1974), 104–105.

25. Franz Liszt, “De la musique religieuse [Die Kirchenmusik],” in *Sämtliche Schriften, Band I: Frühe Schriften*, ed. Rainer Kleinertz (Leipzig: Breitkopf und Härtel, 2000), 58. Translation by Charles Suttoni in Franz Liszt, *An Artist’s Journey: Lettres d’un bachelier ès musique, 1835–1841* (Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 1989), 236–237.

26. Paul Merrick, *Revolution and Religion in the Music of Liszt* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1987), 100.

27. Carl Dahlhaus, *Nineteenth-Century Music*, trans. J. Bradford Robinson (Berkeley: University of California Press, 1989), 184. Carl Dahlhaus, *Die Musik des 19. Jahrhunderts* (Wiesbaden: Akademische Verlagsgesellschaft Athenaion, 1980), 152.

28. Characteristically enough, the premiere of the Requiem was given on 22 May 1874 at San Marco in Milan as part of the liturgy, and was immediately followed by performances at La Scala, the epicenter of Italian operatic music.

29. See “Musikalisches aus Italien,” in *Briefe und Schriften*, ed. Marie von Bülow, 8 vols. (Leipzig, 1896–1908); vol. 3 (*Ausgewählte Schriften*, 1850–1892), 340–352. David Rosen, *Verdi: “Requiem”* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1995), 12. The Viennese performance was scheduled for 11 June 1875, immediately following the Paris and London premieres.

30. Eduard Hanslick, *Musikalische Stationen* [Die “Moderne Oper,” Part 2] (Berlin, 1880), 5–8; translated in Eduard Hanslick, *Music Criticisms 1846–1899*, trans. and ed. Henry Pleasants (London: Penguin, 1963), 162–163.

31. Dahlhaus, *Nineteenth-Century Music*, 184. Dahlhaus, *Die Musik des 19. Jahrhunderts*, 152.

Works Cited

- Albrechtsberger, Johann Georg. *Gründliche Anweisung zur Composition*. Leipzig, 1790.
- Beller-McKenna, Daniel. *Brahms and the German Spirit*. Cambridge, MA: Harvard UP, 2004.
- Bülow, Hans von. *Briefe und Schriften*. Edited by Marie von Bülow, 8 vols. Leipzig, 1896–1908.
- Dahlhaus, Carl. *Die Musik des 19. Jahrhunderts*. Wiesbaden: Akademische Verlagsgesellschaft Athenaion, 1980.
- . *Nineteenth-Century Music*. Trans. by J. Bradford Robinson. Berkeley: U of California P, 1989.
- Daverio, John. *Robert Schumann: Herald of a “New Poetic Age.”* Oxford: Oxford UP, 1997.
- Fux, Johann Joseph. *Gradus ad parnassum, oder Anführung zur regelmäßigen musikalischen Composition*. Trans. by Lorenz Mizlern. Leipzig: Mizlerischen Buchverlag, 1742.
- Hanslick, Eduard. *Musikalische Stationen* [Die “Moderne Oper,” Part 2]. Berlin, 1880.
- . *Music Criticisms 1846–1899*. Trans. and edited by Henry Pleasants. London: Penguin, 1963.
- Harich, Johann. “Beethoven in Eisenstadt.” *Burgenlaendische Heimatblaetter* 21 (1959): 179.
- Heine, Heinrich. *Die romantische Schule*. Halle a Saale: Otto Hendel, n.d.
- . *The Romantic School and Other Essays*. Trans. by Helen Mustard and edited by Jost Hermand & Robert C. Holub. New York: Continuum, 1985.
- Hoffmann, Ernst Theodor Amadeus. *E. T. A. Hoffmann, Musikalische Novellen und Aufsätze, Band II: Musikalische Aufsätze*. Edited by Edgar Istel. Regensburg: Gustav Bosse, 1921.
- . *E. T. A. Hoffmann’s Musical Writings: Kreisleriana, The Poet and the Composer, Music Criticism*. Trans. by Martyn Clarke & edited by David Charlton. New York: Cambridge UP, 1989.
- Jasper, David. *The Sacred and Secular Canon in Romanticism: Preserving the Sacred Truths*. New York: St. Martin’s Press, 1999.
- Kastner, Emerich, ed. *Ludwig van Beethovens sämtliche Briefe*. Tutzing: Hans Schneider, 1975.
- Koch, Heinrich Christoph. *Musikalisches Lexicon*. Frankfurt am Main, 1802.
- Kunze, Stefan, ed. *Ludwig van Beethoven: Die Werke im Spiegel seiner Zeit—Gesammelte Konzertberichte und Rezensionen bis 1830*. Laaber: Laaber Verlag, 1987.
- Liszt, Franz. *Sämtliche Schriften, Band I: Frühe Schriften*. Edited by Rainer Kleinertz. Leipzig: Breitkopf und Härtel, 2000.
- Mac Intyre, Bruce C. *The Viennese Concerted Mass of the Early Classic Period*. Ann Arbor, MI: UMI Research Press, 1986.
- Merrick, Paul. *Revolution and Religion in the Music of Liszt*. Cambridge: Cambridge UP, 1987.

- Pauly, Reinhard G. "The Reforms of Church Music under Joseph II." *Musical Quarterly* 43 (1957): 372–382.
- Perényi, Eleanor. *Liszt: The Artist as Romantic Hero*. Boston: Little, Brown and Company, 1974.
- Rosen, David. *Verdi: "Requiem."* Cambridge: Cambridge UP, 1995.
- Runestad, Cornell Jesse. "The Masses of Joseph Haydn: A Stylistic Study." PhD diss., University of Illinois at Urbana–Champaign, 1970.
- Scheibe, Johann Adolf. *Critischer Musikus*. Leipzig: Breitkopf, 1745.
- Senner, Wayne M., Robin Wallace, and William Meredith, eds. *The Critical Reception of Beethoven's Compositions by his German Contemporaries*. Lincoln: U of Nebraska P, 1999.
- Shedlock, J. S., trans. *Beethoven's Letters*. New York: Dover, 1972.
- Solomon, Maynard. *Beethoven*. New York: Schirmer Books, 1977.
- Wagner, Richard. *Gesammelte Schriften und Dichtungen*. Leipzig: Breitkopf und Härtel, 1912–1914.
- Williams, Adrian. *Portrait of Liszt By Himself and His Contemporaries*. Oxford: Clarendon, 1990.